

# CATCH ME IF YOU CAN

Glamour, Deception & The Chase



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# The Ultimate Cat-and-Mouse Game



## The Hunted: Frank Abagnale Jr.

A master of deception and brilliant forger who becomes the most successful bank robber in U.S. history—all before his 18th birthday.



## The Hunter: Carl Hanratty

A methodical, relentless FBI agent whose prime mission is to capture Frank and bring him to justice, but who remains perpetually one step behind.



FRAUD

FORGERY

PURSUIT

# “A Breezy Masterpiece”

“Steven Spielberg crafts a film that’s stylish, breezily entertaining, and surprisingly sweet.”

— Rotten Tomatoes Consensus

“A story too preposterous to have been been invented by a screenwriter.”

— Roger Ebert

“You can’t help supporting the quick-witted, dynamic aptitude of my favourite con artist.” — The Guardian



# The Catalyst of the Con



## The Foundation

Raised in Bronxville, New York. A happy childhood shattered when his mother cheats and walks out.

## The First Hustle

At age 15, Frank swindles his own father out of \$3,400 using a Mobil credit card scheme with petrol station attendants.

## The Motivation

As Ebert notes, adolescent trauma drives the fraud. The con begins not just for money, but as an attempt to reclaim status and put his broken family back together.

# The Illusion of Effortlessness

## The Strategy

Frank succeeds by **"never seeming to try very hard"** (Ebert). He does not plan elaborate cons; he seamlessly exploits immediate opportunities.

## The Classroom Bluff

Expecting a substitute teacher, a young Frank effortlessly walks in, writes his name on the board, and commands the students to tell him what chapter they are on.



## The Philosophy

"Most people will take you at face value until they have reason to do otherwise."

# The Art of the Bluff



## Pan Am Co-Pilot

**The Method:** Dazzled his way into the cockpit through sheer charm and assumed authority.

**The Bluff:** When offered a ride, casually disarmed the experienced flight crew by asking, "It's been awhile. Which one is the jump seat?"



## Pediatrician

**The Method:** Faked his way into a hospital supervisory role without ever attending medical school.

**The Bluff:** Avoided disaster by letting the terrified interns do all the actual medical work while he managed the administrative facade.



## Lawyer

**The Method:** Actually passed the Louisiana bar exam naturally, but without any underlying law degree.

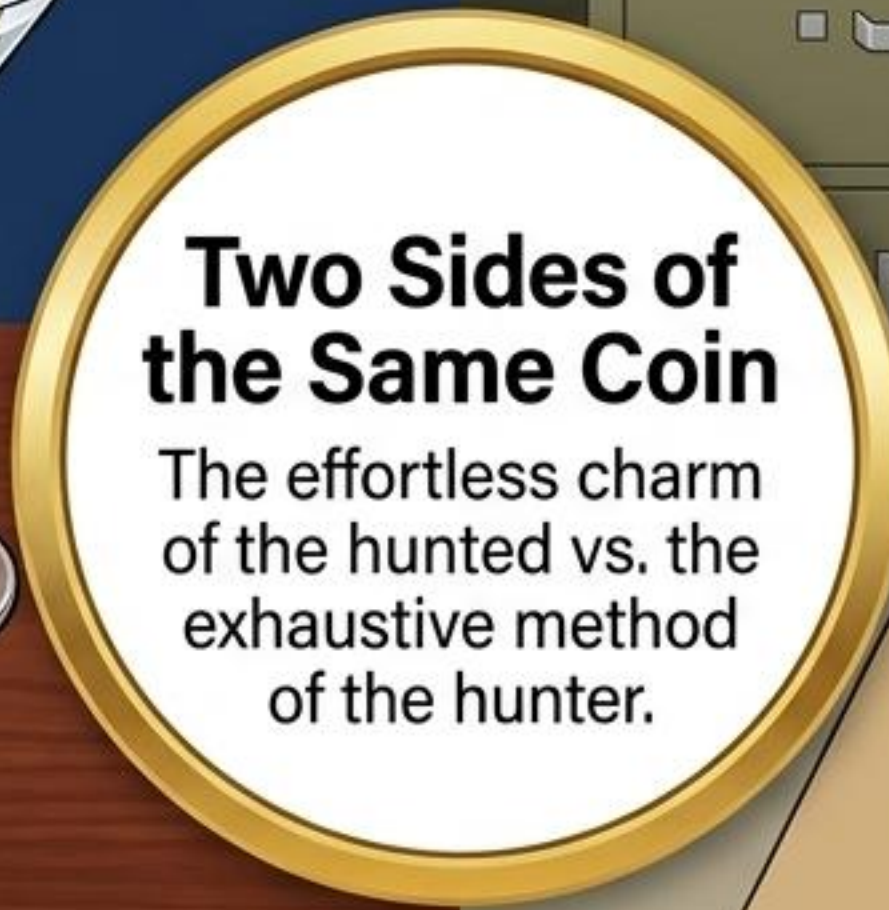
**The Bluff:** Survived a grilling from a suspicious District Attorney about a Berkeley law professor by improvising: "The dog died."

# The Hunted

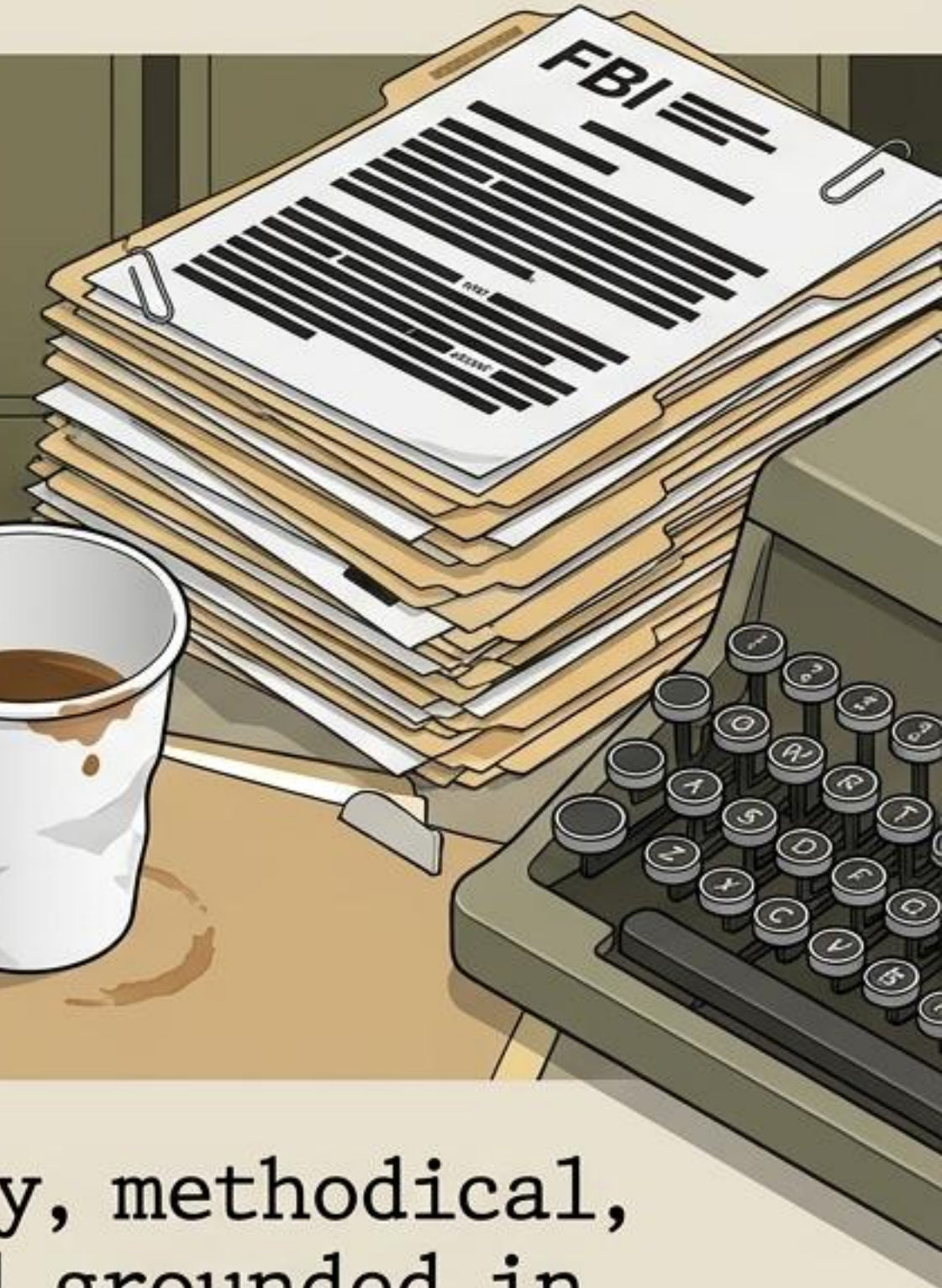


**Frank: Breezy, charismatic, thriving on the exhilarating illusion of wealth and status.**

# The Hunter



**Carl: Gritty, methodical, lonely, and grounded in forensic persistence.**



# THE METHODICAL HUNTER

## AGENT: CARL HANRATTY

### The Mission

A relentless quest to capture a ghost who leaves a trail of millions in bogus checks across international borders.

### The Paradox

Carl is devoid of glamour and social grace, yet he is the ONLY person who possesses a comprehensive overview of Frank's versatile, world-class genius.

### The Evolution

Moves from deep frustration to grudging respect. He recognizes a natural criminal talent that others dismiss simply because of the suspect's youth.

CONFIDENTIAL

EVIDENCE

# Always One Step Ahead



## Improvisation (Frank)



Relies on quick thinking when cornered.

**Key Incident:** Caught at gunpoint in a motel room, Frank effortlessly impersonates a Secret Service agent to walk right past Hanratty with his counterfeit plates.



## Forensics (Carl)



Relies on systemic tracking and endless paper trails.

Carl methodically pieces together routing numbers, magnetic ink decals, and geographic patterns of the forged checks.



*French  
Hotel cocktail  
napkin*

# The Lonely Christmas



*“You didn’t have anyone else to call.” — Carl Hanratty*

The tragic irony: Beneath the wealth and the women, Frank is a sad, lonely teenager. The only honest relationship in the impostor’s life is with the very man trying to lock him up.

# Seeking a Patriarch

## Frank Sr.

Teaches the art of the hustle and how to project the appearance of success. ("Two little mice fell in a bucket of cream...")

Loving, but ultimately powerless, bankrupt, and tragic. Unable to protect his son from reality.

## Carl Hanratty

Teaches the inescapable reality of consequences, boundaries, and rigid institutional structure.

Eventually offers salvation and a future, providing the paternal boundaries Frank desperately craves but runs from.



# Selling the American Dream

## The Facade

Society in the 1960s was obsessed with the sheer appearance of success—the tailored uniform, the confident swagger, the professional title.

## The Exploitation

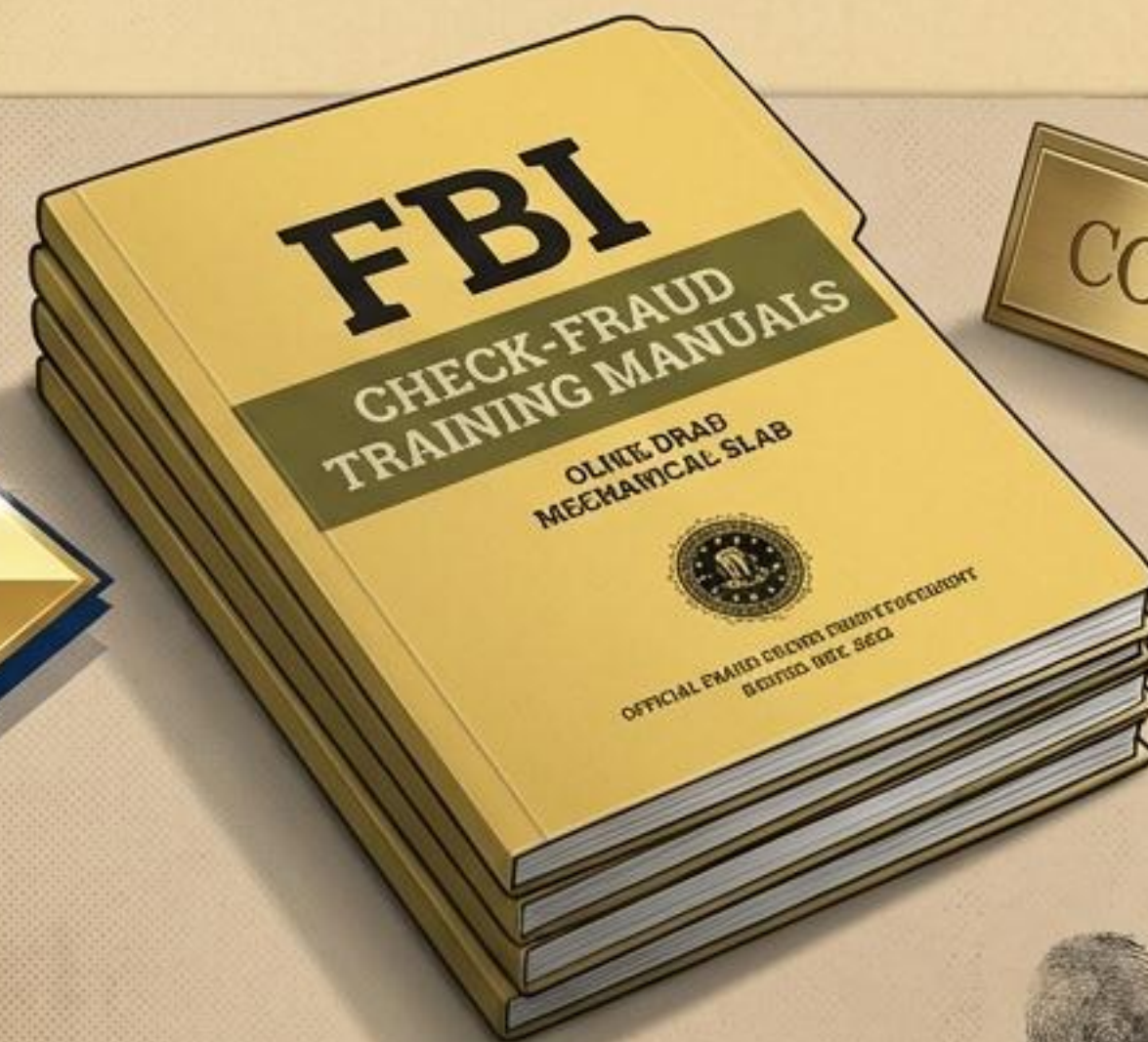
Frank's true genius is realizing a flaw in the system: if you look the part flawlessly, no one ever asks to see the credentials.

## The Prison

The illusion of freedom becomes an ultimate prison. The better Frank becomes at being someone else, the further he gets from his true self.

HEAVY METAL  
FBI

# From Predator to Protector



The Resolution: The ultimate redemption arc. Following his capture in France, Frank's unique criminal mind becomes the FBI's greatest asset. The deception gives way to reality as he finds a legitimate family and purpose within the Bureau, working side-by-side with his former hunter to design secure banking systems.

# The Enduring Con

**CASE CLOSED**

An effortlessly watchable masterpiece that balances the thrill of a high-stakes heist with the profound vulnerability of a lost boy. It remains a testament to the fact that the most preposterous fictions are often outdone by true stories of human audacity.

*JET TO* PARIS

